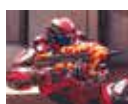


PewDiePie reaches another milestone

Felix "PewDiePie" Kjellberg has become first content creator on YouTube to reach 90 million subscribers <https://dgit.in/Apr19-97>



Halo 5 goes full-on Pizza Mode

Players in Halo 5 received the "Last Slice skin", a freebie to celebrate the Master Chief Collection PC Release <https://dgit.in/Apr19-98>

GGGGGah!

I'm fed up of the term 5G. Because of this silly cover story that Ed insisted on, the whole office was 5G-this and 5G-that, and I've had enouggggggh!

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

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on't get me wrong, I love bandwidth – the more the better. However, 5G is supposed to be about

much, much more than your mobile phones. Because of the way it's set up, it will allow far more devices to connect per base station, and because of the higher frequency, there are going to be far more base stations than before – one every few hundred feet in really crowded cities. This means we will all be subjected to unprecedented levels of non-ionising radiation. For those of you who don't know, non-ionising radiation is supposed to be safe for humans, because it cannot cause electrons to jump out of their shells and create ions. X-rays and Gamma rays can do this, and that's why we need to minimise the amount of X-rays we take, or else we risk causing damage to our cells and our DNA.

Now, let's be clear, no link between cancer and non-ionising radiation has ever been found. In fact, the percentage of cancer patients in developed countries is pretty steady over the past

20 years, while the amount of cell-phone radiation we have been exposed to has increased exponentially. There is, however, some evidence that very high doses of cell phone radiation can reduce motility of human sperm – you should stop carrying your phone in your pant-pocket... Some critics of 5G suggest that because of the increased base stations and as a result, increased radiation, there is a need to do more indepth study before it is rolled out, rather than after. For now though, due to the sheer lack of evidence to the contrary, we should all assume that 5G is perfectly safe, and not believe the conspiracy theories about "big wireless".



5G is not just a new mobile network; it is so much more. Yes mobile brands are the ones currently hyping it the most, and service providers are in a race to be the first and gobbling spectrum across the globe, but the true potential of the technology lies in the internet of things (IoT). That won't stop people from shoving ads down your throats for brand new phones that are 5G capable. But so what? What are you going to do with 800 Mbps speeds on your phone really? Yes, sure, 4 years from now there will be apps

and services that will pop up and be innovative and disruptive, and they will be that way because they were thought up in a world where gigabit phone speeds are the norm. But in the next year or two, what do you really see yourself doing with those speeds that justify you shelling out a small fortune for a phone that supports it?

In India especially, with gigabit fibre being marketed to us for really cheap, and being amongst the most spoiled in the world when it comes to mobile data costs, do you honestly think mobile service providers are going to shell out the fortune that will be needed to, say, cover cities like Mumbai and Delhi with 5G for all just to get a paltry few hundred rupees from you for data? They might still do it, but the goal will be far more future-looking and encompass far more than just providing you mobile data. We'll know more when the spectrum is auctioned. They're going to push to own more than just your mobile connection – home broadband, entertainment packages, gaming, smart homes, etc at a personal level, and also tying up with governments for contracts to run your streetlights, traffic lights, surveillance... you name it. However, this will kill of competition, and I expect there will be no more than a couple of serious players left when the dust settles, which stifles innovation and drives prices up, not down.

However, what I hate most about 5G is what it will do to life in general. It's not like we have too little of the internet in our lives now... It reminds me of the stupid USB phase we went through in 2007, where utter rubbish was being sold to us with the term USB attached. With 5G, expect even more pointless yet interesting gadgets and gizmos to appear, all connecting to a 5G network, and achieving nothing. We're going to get dumber by the second too, because all that bandwidth is going to give rise to even more pointless pastimes. If you think TikTok is a pointless waste of time, wait till you see how pointless some 5G services will be. All I can say is arggggggh!